Chapter 26

Kiran after Tihar:
Writing for Posterity

KIRAN REPORTED BACK TO THE DELHI POLICE. THE TRANSFER ORDER put her in charge of 'training and policy implementation'. Overnight, even training was withdrawn and she was left with only policy implementation. Nobody explained why the order was changed. In the area of policy implementation, there was nothing spelt out. It was now for Kiran to decide what she wanted to do: sit around and do nothing. (For the then police commissioner had told her: 'You have a car, a driver and personal staff. You can just stay put.') Or she could do her own thing. She chose the latter, for which she had done prior homework. Kiran had secured the prestigious Jawaharlal Nehru Fellowship while she was working at Tihar. It appeared as if Kiran had a sixth sense guiding her when she had applied for the Nehru Fellowship. On being asked about this aspect, she replied:

> When I applied for the Nehru Fellowship, Tihar Jail reforms were at their peak and everything was going smoothly. But I had a feeling that these reforms would be derailed as they were too good to last in our envious system. Therefore, it was necessary to document the transformation for posterity. It might also be self-respecting to leave on my own terms in case an unwanted situation arose, which may hurt the reform process. I had something telling me that I may have to take this decision at any time, sooner or later. In fact, I did consider leaving while it was smooth, and discussed it with my colleague Jaydev Sarangi. After discussions, I decided to postpone writing for the Fellowship in order to complete the tasks in hand, such as: computerization, laying the cable network, health plans consolidation, linkage with universities for encouraging pure research, NGO and industry participation for vocational training and earnings to support families who are victims for no fault. All to institutionalize reforms. I believed that if we as a team could give Tihar one more year, we could take it where we wanted it to be. But my gut feeling was right. Envy struck and I had to leave Tihar.
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> Back in Delhi Police I saw nothing really waiting for me. I felt free. In fact, they set me free from any expectations and official duties. I now was not leaving anything pending. I now decided to go in for writing [using my Nehru Fellowship] to bring out the book *It's Always Possible*.

Kiran applied for study leave and got into an 'author mode' with a total sense of freedom and with her habitual optimism. She took to writing and finally published the book (three years later).

It's Always Possible was published with a CD-ROM attached, another first in many ways (for more information see Chapter 27).